



Linux to overtake Windows on netbooks by 2013

New research projects that in 2009 Linux will represent 32 per cent of global netbook sales, far higher than the seven per cent figure claimed by Microsoft. The market data from ABI Research estimates that Linux will overtake Windows on netbooks by 2013, largely due to sales in less-developed countries, as per DesktopLinux.com.

ABI Research's study, *Netbooks, MIDs and Mobile CE Market Data*, says 35 million netbooks will be shipped by manufacturers in 2009. Asus dominated the netbook category in 2007 when it debuted the Eee PC, and Acer made a big push in Q4 2008 to lead the second year.

"74 per cent of 2008 netbook shipments bore the brand names of just three vendors—Acer, Asus and Samsung," explained Jeff Orr, senior analyst, ABI. "However, the rapid growth of netbooks as a second computer in developed markets will be eclipsed in the coming years by vendors targeting developing nations offering netbooks as the first Internet PC at homes."

ABI Research forecasts UMDs (ultra-mobile devices --a combination of netbooks, MIDs and UMPCs) to reach 124 million systems in 2011.

Orr believes laptop vendors may soon "reinvent the UMPC," bringing down the low-end laptop price to \$500 through ultra-low voltage machines. "That could affect some netbook sales in developed markets, especially among the business users."

As netbook markets thrive, the mobile consumer electronics category, which is expected to account for only about two million device shipments this year, is forecast to top 50 million in 2014. This market is currently led by connected personal navigation devices (PNDs) and eBook readers. Amazon's Kindle has lots of competition coming from the Barnes & Noble Nook, Sony Daily Edition, iRex, Plastic Logic Que and others.



White House goes Drupal

WhiteHouse.gov, the official website for the White House and President Barack Obama, now runs on open source. The White House has launched a new version of its website, powered by the Drupal content management system and the Apache Solr search server.

"We wanted to improve the tools used by thousands of people who come to WhiteHouse.gov to engage with White House officials, and each other, in meaningful ways," White House spokesman Nick Shapiro said in an e-mail to InformationWeek. "We now have a technology platform to get more and more voices on the site. This is state-of-the-art technology, and the government is a participant in it."



Adobe AIR 2 beta for Linux, released

Adobe Systems Incorporated has announced that beta versions of Adobe AIR 2 and Adobe Flash Player 10.1 are now available. According to the release information, with AIR 2, developers can create more reliable and feature-rich applications in the desktop context, and they can easily add AIR 2 functionality to update current AIR 1.0 applications.

New AIR 2 features include enhanced support for mass storage devices and native application processes, as well as peer-to-peer and UDP networking. Flash Player 10.1, on the other hand, is supposed to be the first consistent browser runtime release of the Open Screen Project that will enable uncompromised Web browsing of expressive applications, content and high definition (HD) videos across the desktop and devices. The beta versions are available as free downloads from Adobe Labs.

A racing bike with Linux inside

Mavizen, the manufacturing arm of the TTXGP, recently announced the TTX02 at this year's SEMA. The Mavizen TTX02 electric motorbike is shipping not only with a chassis and drivetrain, but with an open source Linux OS, Web server, USB-based system bus and Wi-Fi connectivity. Production will be limited to just 50 units when the Mavizen TTX02 arrives sometime in the first quarter of next year, reports Engadget.